

Licensing ACC-Marked External Possession in Korean^{*}

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Abstract

This paper looks at the accusative (ACC) marked external possession construction (EPC) in Korean, seeking to identify its licensing conditions, an outstanding problem in the literature. I propose that ACC-marked EP sentences in Korean are licensed if they answer the question under discussion (QUD) and if the possessum (PM) represents what I call the *Target* of the event under description in which the possessor (PR) is the Theme *or* if the PR is what I call the *Receiver* of the event in which the PM is the Theme. I also propose that there are at least three structural possibilities for ACC-marked EP sentences which correlate with the argument status of the PR and the PM at issue and the inalienable versus non-inalienable possession relation that holds between them. The proposed analysis will be shown to account for various properties of the ACC-marked EPC in ways that improve on the existing analyses including the affectedness-based analyses. It also provides reasons to treat truly inalienable EPCs differently from non-truly inalienable ones even in languages like Korean.

1. Introduction

Typological research shows that the world's languages have a way of encoding external possession in addition to internal possession. In an internal possession construction (IPC), the possessor (PR) occurs inside the maximal nominal projection containing the possessum

^{*}This paper is a descendant of the term-paper I wrote for the Genitive Seminar (LING 830) co-taught by professors Barbara H. Partee and Margaret Speas at UMass Amherst in Fall 2000. I therefore thank everyone who helped me to write that term-paper, and this includes Ellen Woolford, Carson Schütze, Kyle B. Johnson, the late Emmon Bach, Hosuk Yoon, and Makoto Kadowaki, not to mention Barbara Partee and Peggy Speas. I also wish to take this opportunity to thank Angelika Kratzer and James Hye Suk Yoon for offering me feedback on my first generals paper, which was also related to a Case phenomenon in Korean and other languages, as their feedback proved to be helpful in so many ways as I tried to develop this paper.

As one can see from comparing (1a) and (1b), in the ACC-marked EPC in Korean, the PR and the PM form separate nominal projections, but they occur bearing the same case, namely, ACC, so this construction is treated as instantiating the multiple accusative construction (MAC) in the literature (see, e.g., Kim 2000; and references there).¹

- Korean also has two additional EPCs, where the PR and the PM occur bearing nominative (NOM) or dative cases, so are treated as instantiating the multiple nominative construction (MNC) and the multiple dative construction, respectively. Yet the ACC-marked EPC has received greatest attention because exactly what licenses it is still poorly understood: As (2) shows, the PR and the PM occurring in this construction need not stand in an inalienable part-whole relation. However, it is not the case that just any PM may occur, unlike the case in the NOM-marked EPC (see Ryu 2014; and references there). For example, while kinship terms may freely occur in the MNC, as illustrated in (3), they may not in the MAC, as illustrated in (4).

- ¹Unless explicitly indicated, the Korean data presented in this paper have been constructed by the author and their grammaticality has been verified by three other Korean speakers. As to their transcription, the Yale Romanization (Martin 1992) and the Leipzig Glossing Rules have been adopted. Additionally, the following abbreviations have been used: CONN: connective; HON: honorific; IMPRF: imperfective; INFML: informal style; N.PST: non-past; TOP: topic.

- (3) **Pat-i** (nay-ka al-ki-lo-nun) **emeni-ka** (MNC)
 Pat-NOM I-NOM know-NML-INST-TOP mother-NOM
 uysa-i-si-Ø-ta.
 doctor-COP-N.PST-HON-DECL
 ‘It is Pat whose mother is (to my knowledge) a doctor.’
- (4) ***Pat-i** **Chris-lul** (kyosil-eyse) **emeni-lul** cap-ass-ta. (MAC)
 Pat-NOM Chris-ACC classroom-LOC mother-ACC grab-PST-DECL
 Intended: ‘Pat grabbed Chris’s mother (in the classroom).’
 (Adapted from Tomioka and Sim 2007: ex. (11))

In the Korean linguistics literature, the restriction on the ACC-marked EPC has been attributed to what is called the *affectedness condition* (e.g., Yoon 1989, 1990; Tomioka and Sim 2005, 2007).² As authors like Yoon (1997), Kim (2000), Yoon (2015), and Shin (2022) have shown, however, postulating the workings of this condition alone cannot capture the full range of facts since in sentences like (5), the PR nominal is not construed as an affected theme.

- (5) John-i **ku ai-lul** **ilum-ul** al-n-ta. (MAC)
 John-NOM that kid-ACC name-ACC know-IMPRF-DECL
 ‘John knows that kid’s name.’
 (Adapted from Shin 2022: ex. (22))

Given this state of affairs, the present paper looks at the ACC-marked EPC in Korean, with the goal of identifying its licensing conditions. In so doing, it seeks to help settle some of the longstanding issues surrounding the EPCs in Korean, in particular, which between the PR and the PM is the true argument of the predicate, and whether all occurrences of the PM nominals are modifiers of some kind, e.g., secondary predicates that modify the PR or modifiers of the verb, as suggested by authors like Kim (1989, 1990) and Shin (2022), respectively.

I propose in this paper that ACC-marked EP sentences in Korean are licensed if they answer the question under discussion (QUD) (Roberts 1996; Büring 2003) and if the PM represents what I call the *Target* of the event under description in which the PR is the Theme *or* if the PR is what I call the *Receiver* of the event in which the PM is the Theme. I also propose that there are at least three structural possibilities for ACC-marked EP sentences which correlate with the argument status of the PR and the PM at issue and the inalienable versus non-inalienable possession relation that holds between them (compare, a.o., Choe 1986; Yoon 1989; Kim 1989, 1990; Cho 1992; Yoon 1997; Cho 1998, 2000; Kim 2000; Sim 2004; Vermeulen 2005; Tomioka and Sim 2005, 2007; Shin 2022).

In section 2, I identify the licensing conditions for the ACC-marked EPC in Korean by critically reviewing one of the most recent attempts made in the literature, namely, Shin

²The affectedness condition has been shown to be at work in numerous other languages as well, e.g., French (Kayne 1975; Barnes 1985; Guéron 1985), Spanish (Kempchinsky 1992; Cuervo 2003), Hebrew (Berman 1981; Borer and Grodzinsky 1986; Landau 1999), Mandarin (Cheng and Ritter 1987; Yoon 1990), and Swahili (Keach and Rochement 1994). For typological surveys on affectedness conditions on EPCs, see Shibatani 1994, Haspelmath 1999, Payne and Barshi 1999, and O’Connor 2007. For a useful survey on this topic and EPCs as a whole, see Deal 2017.

2022. Along the way, I also remark on some of the influential works on this topic (e.g., Yoon 1989, 2015; Yeon 1999, 2019; Tomioka and Sim 2005, 2007). Section 3 presents an event-based compositional semantic analysis of the construction, implementing the ideas put forth in section 2. Section 4 discusses consequences of the proposed analysis, demonstrating how it may account for various properties of the ACC-marked EPC in Korean in ways that improve on the existing analyses. Section 5 takes up a binding problem noted by Tomioka and Sim (2007) and offers a new perspective on the matter, providing reasons to treat truly inalienable EPCs differently from non-truly inalienable ones even in languages like Korean. Section 6 concludes the paper, with implications for future research.

2. Licensing conditions for the ACC-marked EPC in Korean

Building on some of the previous analyses of the ACC-marked EPC in Korean (e.g., Yoon 1997; Yoon 2015) but strengthening their claims, Shin (2022) argues that the affectedness condition is neither a necessary nor a sufficient condition for the construction. Based on existing typological research (Seiler 1983; Nichols 1992; Bally 1996; Chappell and McGregor 1996; Heine 1997), she also argues that the notion of *inalienable possession* varies from culture to culture, and that different languages, different speech communities, and even different speakers may have a different range of PR-PM pairs occur in their ACC-marked EPCs.³

Shin suggests that in the case of Korean, what licenses its ACC-marked EP sentences is the pragmatic salience of the PR that establishes an inalienable part-of relation with the PM in the given discourse context; and to support this idea, she points out that while (6) is judged fine, (7) is not, and that this is because while our knowledge of the world establishes an inalienable relation between BTS (the famous K-pop group) and the songs and dances they produce, it does not do so for an actor and his/her songs and dances.

- | | | | | |
|-----|--|---------------------------|---|---|
| (6) | Ku-nun
he-TOP | BTS-lul
BTS-ACC | chwum-ul/nolay-lul
dance-ACC/song-ACC | cohaha-n-ta.
like-IMPRF-DECL |
| | ‘He likes BTS’s dance/songs.’ | | | |
| | (Shin 2022: ex. (24)) | | | |
| | | | | |
| (7) | ??Ku-nun
he-TOP | ku
that | paywu-lul
actor-ACC | chwum-ul/nolay-lul
dance-ACC/song-ACC |
| | cohaha-n-ta.
like-IMPRF-DECL | | | |
| | Intended: ‘He likes that actor’s dance/songs.’ | | | |
| | (Shin 2022: ex. (25)) | | | |

To account for the contrast between (6) and (7) and other EP data that resemble (1a), Shin proposes that the inalienable part-of meaning that is construed between a PR and a PM in an EP sentence is derived by shifting the semantics of the PM from an individual-denoting expression to a function of type $\langle\langle e, \langle e, t \rangle \rangle, \langle e, \langle e, t \rangle \rangle\rangle$ by combining it with “a null element expressing an inalienable part-of relationship” (p. 83), as given in (8).

³A similar idea is also suggested by Vergnaud and Zubizarreta (1992), among others.

- ⁵ This fact also presents a problem to Yoon's (1999, 2019) analysis since he claims that for an ACC-marked EP sentence in Korean to be licensed, the PR and the PM must be in *physical contact* or the PM must be a *physically contiguous part* of the PR. More on this in section 4.

Min-Joo Kim

cip-ul swusaykhay-ss-ta.
 house-ACC search-PST-DECL
 ‘The police searched Chris’s house (while/when she was gone).’

I should also point out that there are contexts where sentences like (7) can be felicitously uttered. To see this, consider (12). In this discourse, a variant of (7) is uttered in answer to a *wh*-question. Yet, for this sentence to be judged acceptable, it does not have to be the case that the actor at issue is well known for their singing or dancing or their songs or dances. That this actor can sing or dance may be new information to one of the discourse participants and therefore is “newsworthy” (cf. Yoon 2015) but this does not have to be the case, either.

- (12) A: Jiswu-nun **ku** **paywu-lul** **mwue-l** cohaha-y?
 Jiswu-TOP that actor-ACC what-ACC like-Q.INFML
 ‘What does Jiswu like about that actor?’
- B: Jiswu-nun **ku** **paywu-lul** **chwum-ul/nolay-lul**
 Jiswu-TOP that actor-ACC dance-ACC/song-ACC
 cohaha-y.
 like-DECL.INFML
 ‘Jiswu likes that actor’s dancing/singing (or dances/songs).’

Collectively, this set of facts show that the contextually constructed inalienable part-of relation that Shin imposes on a PR-PM pair that occurs in an ACC-marked EP sentence in Korean is not a necessary nor a sufficient condition for the sentence’s acceptability. It further shows that, just like affectedness, such a relation is a cancelable implicature, rather than an entailment, so should not be part of truth-conditional semantics.

What licenses grammatical and felicitous uses of ACC-marked EP sentences in Korean, then? My answer is that they must meet the following conditions, which I suggest as necessary, rather than sufficient, conditions for reasons to be given in section 5.⁶

- (13) *Necessary conditions for an ACC-marked EP sentence in Korean (my proposal)*
- a. The PR is the Theme of the event under description and the PM represents the Target of that event *or* the PM is the Theme of the event and the PR is the Receiver of the event.
 - b. The sentence answers the QUD.

My motivation for positing (13a) comes from the fact that in all grammatical ACC-marked EP data in Korean, the PR is construed as either the Theme or the affected theme of the event described by the sentence and the PM specifies the entity that stands in a possessed relation to the PR which the meaning of the verb holds true of. The PM only needs to *represent* what I call the Target of the event, however, because in data like (14),

⁶ As we will see in section 5, ACC-marked EP sentences must comply with binding conditions, independently of these conditions.

the PM is not an actual body part of the PR; it merely indicates which part of Chris's body Pat grabbed.

- (14) *Context: Speaker is pointing to a part of their arm.*

Pat-i	Chris-lul	yeki-lul	cap-ass-e.
Pat-NOM	Chris-ACC	here-ACC	grab-PST-DECL.INFML

‘Pat grabbed *this* part of Chris.’

(adapted from Shin 2022: ex. (26))

As for (13b), my motivation for positing it comes from the fact that while (12B) is judged fine, (7) is not, even though the latter also meets (13a), so for an ACC-marked EP sentence to be judged fully acceptable, ensuring that it answers the QUD will be necessary, apart from satisfying the conditions given in (13a).

Under the analysis I have just suggested, what would be problematic data for Shin 2022 are no longer problematic. To take (2) for example, in my analysis, this sentence is judged good because in the event under description, Chris's car is the Theme of the damaging event that Pat caused; Chris is the Receiver of that event; and the sentence answers the QUD, be it a question like “what's the matter?” or “what did Pat do to Chris?”. This outcome is also an improvement on Tomioka and Sim's (2007) analysis since they would incorrectly predict (2) to be ungrammatical based on the fact that the PM of this sentence is not a material part of the PR (more on this in section 5).

The present analysis can handle data like (14) as well. Under the current analysis, (14) is grammatical because (i) it can be felicitously uttered in answer to “what happened?”, “what's the matter?”, or “what did Pat do to Chris?”; (ii) the PM represents the Target of the grabbing event under description; and (iii) the PR is the Theme of that event. Under Shin's analysis, this sentence is incorrectly predicted to be nonsensical because the truth conditions her system generates will inadequately state that the part of their arm *z* that the speaker is pointing at is where Pat grabbed and *z* is an inalienable part of Chris, as given in (15).

- (15) *VP-level meaning of (14) under Shin's (2022) analysis*

$\lambda y \exists z[z = \text{this part}' \wedge \text{inalienable-part-of}'(z)(\text{Chris}') \wedge \text{grab}'(z)(y)]$

Additionally, what I have suggested in (13) captures data like (5) and (6), which are problematic for works like Yoon 1989, 1990 and Tomioka and Sim 2005, 2007, as they would require that the PR nominal of an ACC-marked EP sentence in Korean be an affected theme. On the present analysis, (5) is judged good because (i) the QUD is “who knows the child's name?”; (ii) the PR is the Theme of the event; and (iii) the PM is the Target of that event. For these reasons, we can correctly predict that (5) will be true even if John does not *know* the child. That is, the sentence will be true as long as John knows the child's name, and this is evidenced by the coherence of the discourse in (16). Notice that if the PM nominal is absent from (5), then one cannot continue by saying that John does not know the child, as shown in (17). (Here and below, capitalization indicates focal stress.)

- (16) JOHN₁-i **ku** **ai-lul** **ilum-ul** al-n-ta.
 John-NOM that kid-ACC name-ACC know-IMPRF-DECL
 ‘JOHN₁ knows that kid's name.’

Min-Joo Kim

Haciman *pro*₁ ku ai-nun cal molu-n-ta.
 But that kid-TOP well not.know-IMPRF-DECL
 ‘But he₁ doesn’t know the kid well.’

- (17) JOHN₁-i **ku** **ai-lul** al-n-ta.
 John-NOM that kid-ACC know-IMPRF-DECL
 ‘JOHN_i knows that kid.’
 #Haciman *pro*₁ ku ai-nun cal molu-n-ta.
 But that kid-TOP well not.know-IMPRF-DECL
 ‘But he_i doesn’t know the kid well.’

By the same token, we can explain why one may felicitously utter (6) even if they may not like BTS apart from their singing/dancing or songs/dances; that’s because the target of the verb’s meaning is the PM, not the PR.

With these preliminary results outlined, I turn now to presenting a new formal analysis of the ACC-marked EPC in Korean, implementing the ideas I have informally offered in this section.

3. A new formal analysis of the ACC-marked ECP in Korean

Our discussion in the previous section shows that ACC-marked EP sentences in Korean are subject to different licensing conditions depending on the thematic roles the PR and the PM nominals bear. If the PR is the Theme of the event under description, then the PM specifies the part of the PR that the meaning of the verb holds true of (e.g., (1a)); if the PM functions as the Theme, then the PR indicates the entity that receives the action that is done to the Theme in the event (e.g., (2)).

Based on these descriptive generalizations, I propose that ACC-marked EP sentences in Korean can have two different kinds of syntactic structures depending on which between the PR and the PM functions as the direct object of the verb. In one type, which I call *Type 1*, the PR functions as the direct object and the PM as the restrictor of the verb meaning. Hence, the former merges at SpecVP and the latter merges as complement to V (cf. Larson 1988) (compare, a.o., Shin 2022). In the other type, which I call *Type 2*, the PM functions as the direct object and the PR as some sort of affected theme. Hence, the former merges at SpecVP and the latter merges in a position that is external to VP (compare, a.o., Sim 2004; Tomioka and Sim 2005, 2007; Vermeulen 2005; Kitaoka 2017).

Given the limited scope of this paper, providing a fully-fleshed-out syntax for ACC-marked EP sentences in Korean cannot be attempted here (see Kim 2024 for such an attempt). However, for the sake of concreteness, I will assume that the position that the PR of a Type 2 sentence merges at is Spec of Applicative Phrase (ApplP) in the sense of Pylkkänen (2008).⁷

In addition, I assume that Agents are base-generated at the Spec of Voice Phrase (VoiceP) in the sense of Kratzer (1996) and that VoiceP is located above ApplP.

⁷Pylkkänen (2008) posits more than one type of ApplP, i.e., Low ApplP and High ApplP, and that has been suggested for Korean too (see, e.g., Kim 2011; Kitaoka 2017; Lee and Nie 2022). But for simplicity, I do not make such a differentiation in this paper.

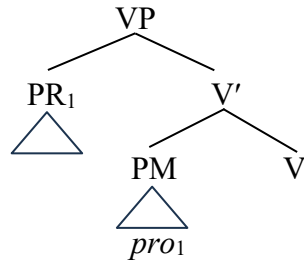
As to how the PR and the PM nominals may receive Case, following authors like Maling and Kim (1992), Wechsler and Lee (1996), and Yoon (2015), among others, I assume that in Korean, V complements and adjuncts can bear whatever Case the verb is capable of assigning, so there can be multiple occurrences of ACC-marked nominals inside the same VP structure, modulo some ordering restrictions noted by authors like Maling and Kim (1992) and Kim (2001). Yet I also assume with Kim (2011) that, in Korean, Appl can assign ACC to the nominal that occurs at its Spec, so the PR of a Type 2 sentence receives its Case from Appl.

Finally, I adopt the prevailing view that in an ACC-marked EP sentence, the PM contains an empty category that bears the same index as the PR (Yoon 2015), and following Vermeulen (2005), I assume that this empty category is a *pro*, based on the fact that a GEN-marked overt pronoun may occur inside the PM nominal, co-indexed with the PM-externally occurring PR, as observed by authors like Cho (1992) and as exemplified in (18)–(19) (but more on this in section 5).

- (18) Pat-i **Chris₁-lul** (kyosil-eyse) [ku₁-uy **phal**]-ul
 Pat-NOM Chris-ACC classroom-LOC he-GEN arm-ACC
 cap-ass-ta.
 grab-PST-DECL
 ‘Pat grabbed Chris₁ by his₁ arm (in the classroom).’
- (19) Pat-i **Chris₁-lul** (ecey) [ku₁-uy **cha**]-lul
 Pat-NOM Chris-ACC yesterday he-GEN car-ACC
 kocangnay-ss-ta.
 break-PST-DECL
 ‘(Yesterday) Pat broke Chris₁’s car on him₁.’

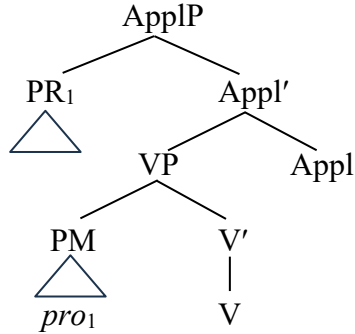
Under these assumptions, then, a Type 1 sentence would have the syntax schematized in (20), and a Type 2 sentence would have the syntax schematized in (21), given that Korean is a head-final language.⁸

- (20) *Syntax of Type 1 cases (e.g., (1a))*



⁸By making these proposals I do not exclude the possibility that some ACC-marked PRs occurring in EP sentences in Korean function as what Yoon (2007) calls *Major Objects*. However, I posit that the syntactic positions they are base-generated in are of two kinds, namely, SpecVP and SpecAppIP; and in this regard, I differ from all authors who have worked on this construction including Kitaoka (2017), who suggests that all ACC-marked PRs occurring in EP sentences in Korean are base-generated at SpecAppIP and as such they function as Major Objects.

(21) *Syntax of Type 2 cases (e.g., (2))*



Turning now to deriving the semantics of ACC-marked EP sentences compositionally, I adopt a neo-Davidsonian event semantics framework (Parsons 1990; Kratzer 1996) and make the following assumptions and hypotheses.

First, the highest PR nominal that occurs in an ACC-marked EP sentence is individual-denoting.

Second, the PM nominal that occurs after the highest PR nominal is also individual-denoting, yet due to the construction-specific type-shifting (TS) rule that I propose in (22), it ends up functioning as an operator that restricts the verb's meaning (compare Kim 1989, 1990). More concretely, it takes the verb's meaning and returns a function of the same type but with a predicate of events that I call *Target* added to it (compare Shin 2022).

Third, Appl introduces a function that takes a VP-level meaning and returns a function of the same type but with two new components added to it, namely, what I call the *Result* of an event and a new thematic role that I call *Receiver*, as given in (23) (compare Tomioka and Sim 2005, 2007). (Here and below, variables of type e range over individuals, variables of type s range over eventualities, and variables of type t range over truth-values; and g abbreviates g_e , the contextually available variable assignment function in the sense of Heim and Kratzer (1998).)

(22) *Construction-specific TS rule that applies to a V complement*
 $\lambda w_e. \lambda P_{\langle e, \langle s, t \rangle \rangle}. \lambda y_e. \lambda e_s '[P(y)(e') \ \& \ \exists z[\text{Target}(z)(e') \ \& \ z = w]]$

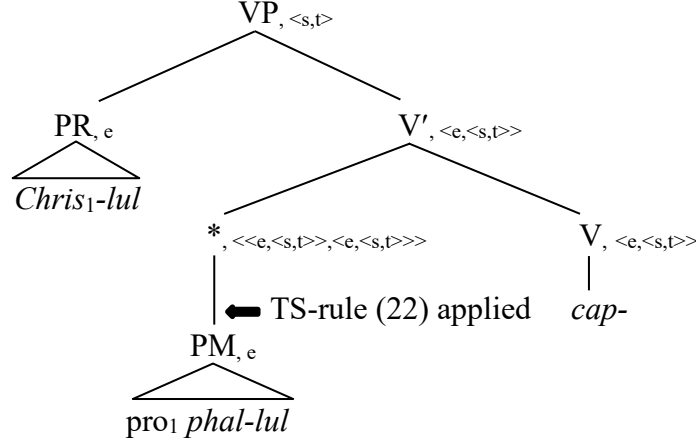
(23) *Semantic contribution of Appl*
 $\llbracket \text{Appl} \rrbracket = \lambda Q_{\langle s, t \rangle}. \lambda x_e. \lambda e_s [Q(e) \ \& \ \exists e' [\text{Result}(e')(e) \ \& \ \exists r [\text{Receiver}(r)(e') \ \& \ r = x]]]$

When we apply these ideas to (1a) and (2), which are repeated below without the locative or temporal adjuncts for simplicity, we obtain (24a) and (25b) as their partial compositional schemes, from which their VP- or ApplP-level meanings given in (24b) and (25b) are generated via the compositional semantic derivational processes spelled out in (26) and (27), respectively.

(1) a. Pat-i **Chris-lul** **phal-ul** cap-ass-ta.
 Pat-NOM Chris-ACC arm-ACC grab-PST-DECL
 'Pat grabbed Chris by the arm.'

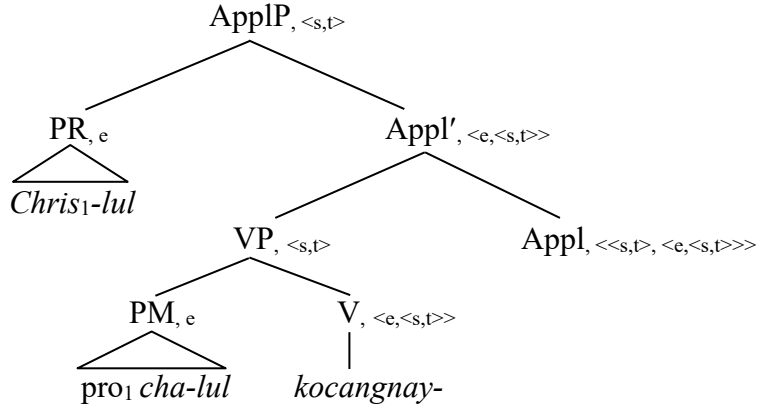
- (2) ?Pat-i **Chris-lul** **cha-lul** kocangnay-ss-ta.
 Pat-NOM Chris-ACC car-ACC break-PST-DECL
 Intended: 'Pat broke Chris's car on him/her/them.'

- (24) a. *VP-level compositional scheme for (1a)*



- b. *VP-level denotation of (1a)*
 $\llbracket VP \rrbracket = \lambda e' [\text{grab}(e') \ \& \ \text{Theme}(\text{Chris})(e') \ \& \ \exists z [\text{Target}(z)(e') \ \& \ z = \text{the.arm.of}(\text{Chris})]]$

- (25) a. *ApplP-level compositional scheme for (2)*



- b. *ApplP-level denotation of (2)*
 $\llbracket \text{ApplP} \rrbracket = \lambda e [\text{break}(e) \ \& \ \text{Theme}(\text{the.car.of}(\text{Chris}))(e)] \ \& \ \exists e' [\text{Result}(e')(e) \ \& \ \exists r [\text{Receiver}(r)(e') \ \& \ r = \text{Chris}]]$

- (26) *Compositional derivational process for (24b)*

$\llbracket \text{cap-} \rrbracket^g = \lambda k \lambda e [\text{grab}(e) \ \& \ \text{Theme}(k)(e)]$

$\llbracket \text{pro}_1 \text{ phal} \rrbracket^g = \text{by lexical entry \& Functional Application (FA) \& } \lambda\text{-reduction}$
 $= \text{the.arm.of}(c_1)$

$\llbracket * \rrbracket^g = \text{via application of the TS-rule in (22)}$
 $= \lambda w \lambda P \lambda y \lambda e' [P(y)(e') \ \& \ \exists z [\text{Target}(z)(e') \ \& \ z = w]](\text{the.arm.of}(c_1))$
 $= \text{via } \lambda\text{-reduction}$

Min-Joo Kim

$$= \lambda P \lambda y \lambda e '[P(y)(e') \& \exists z[\text{Target}(z)(e') \& z = \text{the.arm.of}(c_1)]]$$

$$\begin{aligned} \llbracket V' \rrbracket^g &= \text{via FA} = \llbracket * \rrbracket^g(\llbracket \text{cap-} \rrbracket^g) \\ &= \text{from previous calculation \& by lexical entry} \\ &= \lambda P \lambda y \lambda e '[P(y)(e') \& \exists z[\text{Target}(z)(e') \& z = \text{the.arm.of}(c_1)]] \\ &\quad (\lambda k \lambda e [\text{grab}(e) \& \text{Theme}(k)(e)]) = \text{via } \lambda\text{-reduction} \\ &= \lambda y \lambda e '[\text{grab}(e') \& \text{Theme}(y)(e') \& \exists z[\text{Target}(z)(e') \& z = \text{the.arm.of}(c_1)]] \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} \llbracket VP \rrbracket^g &= \text{via FA} = \llbracket V' \rrbracket^g(\llbracket \text{Chris}_1 \rrbracket^g) \\ &= \text{from previous calculation \& by lexical entry} \\ &= \lambda y \lambda e '[\text{grab}(e') \& \text{Theme}(y)(e') \& \exists z[\text{Target}(z)(e') \& z = \text{the.arm.of}(c_1)]](\text{Chris}_1) = \text{via } \lambda\text{-reduction} \\ &= \lambda e '[\text{grab}(e') \& \text{Theme}(\text{Chris}_1)(e') \& \exists z[\text{Target}(z)(e') \& z = \text{the.arm.of}(c_1)]] = \text{via variable assignment } g(1) = \text{Chris} \\ &= \lambda e '[\text{grab}(e') \& \text{Theme}(\text{Chris})(e') \& \exists z[\text{Target}(z)(e') \& z = \text{the.arm.of}(\text{Chris})]] \end{aligned}$$

(27) *Compositional derivational process for (25b)*

$$\llbracket \text{kocangnay-} \rrbracket^g = \lambda k \lambda e [\text{break}(e) \& \text{Theme}(k)(e)]$$

$$\llbracket \text{pro}_1 \text{ cha} \rrbracket^g = \text{by lexical entry \& FA \& } \lambda\text{-reduction} = \text{the.car.of}(c_1)$$

$$\begin{aligned} \llbracket VP \rrbracket^g &= \text{via FA} = \llbracket \text{kocangnay-} \rrbracket^g(\llbracket \text{pro}_1 \text{ cha} \rrbracket^g) \\ &= \text{by lexical entry \& from previous calculation} \\ &= \lambda k \lambda e [\text{break}(e) \& \text{Theme}(k)(e)](\text{the.car.of}(c_1)) = \text{via } \lambda\text{-reduction} \\ &= \lambda e '[\text{break}(e') \& \text{Theme}(\text{the.car.of}(c_1))(e')] \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} \llbracket \text{Appl}' \rrbracket^g &= \text{via FA} = \llbracket \text{Appl} \rrbracket^g(\llbracket VP \rrbracket^g) \\ &= \text{by lexical entry \& from previous calculation} \\ &= \lambda Q \lambda x \lambda e [Q(e) \& \exists e' [\text{Result}(e')(e) \& \exists r [\text{Receiver}(r)(e') \& r = x]]] \\ &\quad (\lambda e '[\text{break}(e') \& \text{Theme}(\text{the.car.of}(c_1))(e')]) = \text{via } \lambda\text{-reduction} \\ &= \lambda x \lambda e [\text{break}(e) \& \text{Theme}(\text{the.car.of}(c_1))(e) \& \exists e' [\text{Result}(e')(e) \& \exists r [\text{Receiver}(r)(e') \& r = x]]] \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} \llbracket \text{ApplP} \rrbracket^g &= \text{via FA} = \llbracket \text{Appl}' \rrbracket^g(\llbracket \text{Chris}_1 \rrbracket^g) \\ &= \text{from previous calculation \& by lexical entry} \\ &= \lambda x \lambda e [\text{break}(e) \& \text{Theme}(\text{the.car.of}(c_1))(e) \& \exists e' [\text{Result}(e')(e) \& \exists r [\text{Receiver}(r)(e') \& r = x]]](\text{Chris}_1) \\ &= \text{via } \lambda\text{-reduction} \\ &= \lambda e [\text{break}(e) \& \text{Theme}(\text{the.car.of}(c_1))(e) \& \exists e' [\text{Result}(e')(e) \& \exists r [\text{Receiver}(r)(e') \& r = \text{Chris}_1]]] \\ &= \text{via variable assignment } g(1) = \text{Chris} \\ &= \lambda e [\text{break}(e) \& \text{Theme}(\text{the.car.of}(\text{Chris}))(e) \& \exists e' [\text{Result}(e')(e) \& \exists r [\text{Receiver}(r)(e') \& r = \text{Chris}]]] \end{aligned}$$

According to (24b), (1a) will be true if in the grabbing event under description, Chris is the Theme and there is some entity z such that z is the Target of the event and it is Chris's arm, and this agrees with Korean speakers' intuitions about the predicate-level meaning of this sentence, modulo the fact that the Agent of the event should be Pat and the event occurred sometime in the past.

Similarly, what we have obtained for (2) agrees with Korean speakers' intuitions about the meaning of the sentence since according to (25b), the sentence will be true if in the breaking event under description, the Theme is Chris's car and there is some entity e' such that e' is the Result of the event and there is some r such that r is the Receiver of e' and r is Chris, modulo the fact that the Agent of the event has to be Pat and the event occurred sometime in the past.

4. Consequences of the proposed analysis

When we apply the proposed analysis to additional data instantiating the ACC-marked EPC in Korean, we obtain several positive results.

First, we can correctly predict that (12B), which is repeated below as (28a), is grammatical even though the PM does not represent an inalienable part of the PR, presenting a problem to analyses like Shin 2022. In the proposed analysis, this sentence is grammatical because it not only meets the pragmatic condition given in (13b) but also has truth conditions that can be met, namely, what is given in (28b). Moreover, these truth conditions are compatible with Korean speakers' intuitions about the meaning of the sentence.

- (28) a. *Context: Uttered in answer to “what does Jiswu like about that actor?”*
 Jiswu-nun **ku** **paywu-lul** **chwum-ul/nolay-lul**
 Jiswu-TOP that actor-ACC dance-ACC/song-ACC
 cohaha-y.
 like-DECL.INFML
 ‘Jiswu likes that actor’s dancing/singing (or dances/songs).’
 b. *VP-level denotation of (28a)*
 $[[VP]] = \lambda e' [\text{like}(e') \ \& \ \text{Theme}(\text{that actor})(e') \ \& \ \exists z [\text{Target}(z)(e') \ \& \ z = \text{the.singing/dancing.of}(\text{that actor})]]$

Second, we can now more formally account for why (16) is a coherent discourse but (17) is not: The first sentence of (16) is (5), and on the present analysis, it has a VP-level meaning that is given in (29b). According to (29b), this sentence asserts that in the knowing event under description, there is some entity z such that z is the Target of the event and z is the name of the child at issue. The sentence will therefore be true as long as John knows the name of the child even if he does not know him/her well. On the other hand, the first sentence of (17) does not have such a specified meaning, as given in (30b). As a result, the meaning of the verb must hold true of the Theme more holistically than it does in (5). Hence, uttering this sentence and then immediately stating that the verb's meaning does not hold true of the object's denotation gives rise to a contradiction.

Min-Joo Kim

- (29) a. John-i **ku** **ai-lul** **ilum-ul** al-n-ta.
 John-NOM that kid-ACC name-ACC know-IMPRF-DECL
 ‘John knows that kid’s name.’
- b. *VP-level denotation of (29a) (= (5))*
 $[[VP]] = \lambda e' [\text{know}(e') \ \& \ \text{Theme}(\text{that kid})(e') \ \& \ \exists z [\text{Target}(z)(e') \ \& \ z = \text{the.name.of}(\text{that kid})]]$
- (30) a. John-i **ku** **ai-lul** al-n-ta.
 John-NOM that kid-ACC know-IMPRF-DECL
 ‘John knows that kid.’
- b. *VP-level denotation of (30a) (= 1st sentence of (17))*
 $[[VP]] = \lambda e' [\text{know}(e') \ \& \ \text{Theme}(\text{that kid})(e')]$

Third, the proposed analysis lets us capture the semantics of (10) and (11), which are respectively repeated as the first sentences of (31a) and (32a) below. These sentences are problematic for existing analyses including works like Yoon 1989, Yeon 1999, 2019, Tomioka and Sim 2005, 2007, and Shin 2022 because their PMs do not represent an “inalienable” or a “physically contiguous” part of the PR. Under the present analysis, these sentences exemplify what I call Type 2 cases because the Korean verbs *twici-ta* ‘to search’ and *swusaykha-ta* ‘to search’ cannot take animate objects, so what functions as the direct objects in these sentences are the PMs. Given this, we obtain (31b) and (32b) as their ApplP-level denotations, in which *r* need not be a participant in *e*, and this matches Korean speakers’ intuitions about their meanings.

- (31) a. Kyengchal-i **Chris-lul** **kapang-ul** twici-ess-ta.
 police-NOM Chris-ACC bag-ACC search-PST-DECL
 ‘The police searched Chris’s bag.’
 Ku ttay kapang-un Chris-lopwuthe com
 that time bag-TOP Chris-from a.bit
 tteleci-e iss-ess-ta.
 be.away-CONN exist-PST-DECL
 ‘At that time the bag was a bit away from Chris.’
- b. *ApplP-level denotation of (31a) (= (10))*
 $[[ApplP]] = \lambda e [\text{search}(e) \ \& \ \text{Theme}(\text{the.bag.of}(\text{Chris}))(e) \ \& \ \exists e' [\text{Result}(e')(e) \ \& \ \exists r [\text{Receiver}(r)(e') \ \& \ r = \text{Chris}]]]$
- (32) a. Kyengchal-i **Chris-lul** **cip-ul** swusaykhay-ss-ta.
 police-NOM Chris-ACC house-ACC search-PST-DECL
 ‘The police searched Chris’s house.’
 Ku ttay Chris-nun cip-ey eps-ess-ta.
 that time Chris-TOP home-LOC not.exist-PST-DECL
 ‘At that time Chris was not at home.’

- b. *ApplP-level denotation of (32a) (= (10))*
 $[[\text{ApplP}]] = \lambda e[\text{search}(e) \ \& \ \text{Theme}(\text{the.house.of}(\text{Chris}))(e)] \ \& \ \exists e'[\text{Result}(e')(e) \ \& \ \exists r[\text{Receiver}(r)(e') \ \& \ r = \text{Chris}]]]$

Fourth, the proposed analysis provides us with a more proper treatment of (14) than Shin's (2022) analysis does, since it translates the deictic PM *yeki* 'here' as *representing* the part of the PR that serves as the Target of the event under description, as given in (33). That is, what this deictic expression does is to help pick out the referent of the PM by providing a property that holds true of it.

- (33) a. *Context: Speaker is pointing to a part of their arm.*
 Pat-i **Chris-lul** **yeki-lul** cap-ass-e.
 Pat-NOM Chris-ACC here-ACC grab-PST-DECL.INFML
 'Pat grabbed *this* part of Chris.'
- b. *VP-level denotation of (33a) (= (14))*
 $[[\text{VP}]] = \lambda e'[\text{grab}(e') \ \& \ \text{Theme}(\text{Chris})(e') \ \& \ \exists z[\text{Target}(z)(e') \ \& \ z = \text{this.part.of}(\text{Chris})]]]$

Fifth, the present analysis correctly predicts the acceptability differences between data like (34) and (35), thereby letting us make sense of why in some cases, establishing a physical contact between the PR and the PM may be necessary for the grammaticality of the ACC-marked EP sentence at issue, as has been claimed by Yeon (1999, 2019).⁹ Under the current analysis, both (34) and (35) exemplify Type 2 cases, but they have a different acceptability because it is much easier to construe Chris as the Receiver of the event under description in (35) than it is in (34): (35) explicitly states that Chris was inside of the car that Pat was kicking, so one can infer that she was directly impacted by the kicking event as it was happening.

- (34) *Context: In answer to "what happened?" or "what did Pat do to Chris?"*
 ??Ecey Pat-i **Chris-lul** **cha-lul** cha-ss-e.
 Yesterday Pat-NOM Chris-ACC car-ACC kick-PST-DECL.INFML
 Intended: 'Yesterday Pat kicked Chris on the car.'
- (35) *Context: In answer to "what happened?" or "what did Pat do to Chris?"*
 (?)Ecey Pat-i **Chris_i-lul** *pro*₁ tha-ko
 Yesterday Pat-NOM Chris-ACC ride-CONN
 iss-te-n **cha-lul** cha-ss-e.
 AUX-IMPRF-REL car-ACC kick-PST-DECL.INFML
 'Pat kicked Chris_i on the car when she_i was inside of it.'
 (Lit.: 'Pat kicked Chris_i on the car that she_i was inside of.')

By a similar reasoning, we can correctly predict, and also account for, the acceptability difference between sentences like (36) and (37): We predict (37) to be judged

⁹Similar constraints have also been observed to be at work in other languages such as Spanish (see, e.g., Tuggy 1980) and Hebrew (see, e.g., Berman 1981). So what is being claimed here may carry over to such languages as well.

Min-Joo Kim

much better than (36) because in the former, but not in the latter, the verb *cheyphoha-ta* ‘to arrest’ co-occurs with the semi-aspectual auxiliary *ga-ta* meaning ‘to go’ and this conventionally implicates that there is someone that was left in the scene, being affected by the consequence of the event under description (cf. Shibatani 1994).

(36) *Context: In answer to “what happened to Chris”?*

*Kyengchal-i	Chris-lul	pwumonim-ul
Police-NOM	Chris-ACC	parents-ACC
cheyphohay-ss-e.		
arrest-PST-DECL.INFML		
Intended ‘The police arrested Chris’s parents.’		

(37) *Context: In answer to “what happened to Chris”?*

Kyengchal-i	Chris-lul	pwumonim-ul
Police-NOM	Chris-ACC	parents-ACC
cheyphoha-y	ka-ss-e.	
arrest-CONN	go-PST-DECL.INFML	
‘The police arrested Chris’s parents and took them away (from her).’		

Sixth, the present analysis predicts that if what I call Type 2 sentences occur as *wh*-questions, then their acceptability will be enhanced because they presuppose the existence of some *r* such that *r* is the Receiver of the result of the event under description, and this prediction is borne out, as exemplified in (38A). Notice also that what is given in (36) can be judged fine if it is uttered in answer to (38A), as shown in (38B). On the present analysis, this is expected because the presupposition of (38A) facilitates making the existential assertion that (38B) makes regarding the Receiver of the event under description. Given this, we can now begin making testable predictions as to what kinds of presuppositional contexts may license ACC-marked EP sentences in Korean.

(38) *Context: A and B are friends.*

A:	Kyengchal-i	NWUKWU-lul	pwumonim-ul
	Police-NOM	who-ACC	parents-ACC
	cheyphohay-ss-e?		
	arrest-PST-Q.INFML		
	‘Who did the police arrest the parents of?’		
B:	Kyengchal-i	CHRIS-lul	pwumonim-ul
	Police-NOM	Chris-ACC	parents-ACC
	cheyphohay-ss-e.		
	arrest-PST-DECL.INFML		
	‘The police arrested CHRIS’s parents.’		

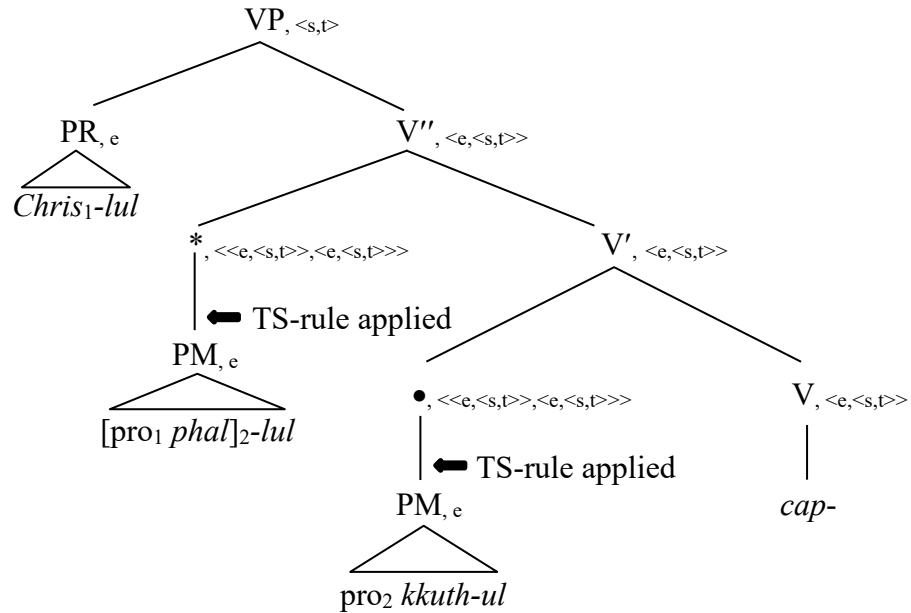
Finally, the analysis advanced here enables us to make a fine-grained distinction between various types of multiple ACC-marked EP sentences in Korean while capturing the fact that in Korean EPCs multiple ACC-marked nominals may co-occur, provided that

they form PR-PM pairs and their linear order reflects this semantic relation between them.¹⁰ To see this, consider first (39).

- (39) Pat-i Chris-lul phal-ul kkuth-ul cap-ass-ta.
 Pat-NOM Chris-ACC arm-ACC end-ACC grab-PST-DECL
 ‘Pat grabbed Chris by the end of her arm.’

Under the present analysis, (39) instantiates a Type 1 case, so its VP-level meaning given in (40b) is derived in the way schematized in (40a) via the processes spelled out in (40c). According to this compositional scheme, the PM *kkuth-ul* ‘the end’ combines with the V’s meaning after undergoing type-shifting via the rule given in (22) and then the outcome of this computation combines with the PM *phal-ul* ‘the arm’ after undergoing type-shifting via the rule in (22) as well (compare Cho 1998, 2000). And according to (40b), (39) will be true if in the grabbing event under description, the Theme is Chris and there are two Targets for the event, the end of Chris’s arm and her arm; however, since these two Targets stand in a material part-whole relation, we interpret the sentence as meaning that there was some grabbing event *e* and in that event the Theme was Chris and the Target was Chris’s arm and the more specific part of that Target was the end of her arm.

- (40) a. *VP-level compositional scheme for (39)*



- b. *VP-level denotation of (39)*

$\llbracket \text{VP} \rrbracket = \lambda e [\text{grab}(e) \ \& \ \text{Theme}(\text{Chris})(e) \ \& \ \exists z [\text{Target}(z)(e) \ \& \ z = \text{the.end.of}(\text{the.arm.of}(\text{Chris}))] \ \& \ \exists v [\text{Target}(v)(e) \ \& \ v = \text{the.arm.of}(\text{Chris})]]$

¹⁰For example, if there are three ACC-marked nominals co-occur, then the first and the second nominals must form one PR-PM pair, and then the second and the third nominals must form another PR-PM pair; see, e.g., Choe 1986, Kim 1989, 1990, Maling and Kim 1992, Cho 1992, and Cho 1998, 2000.

Min-Joo Kim

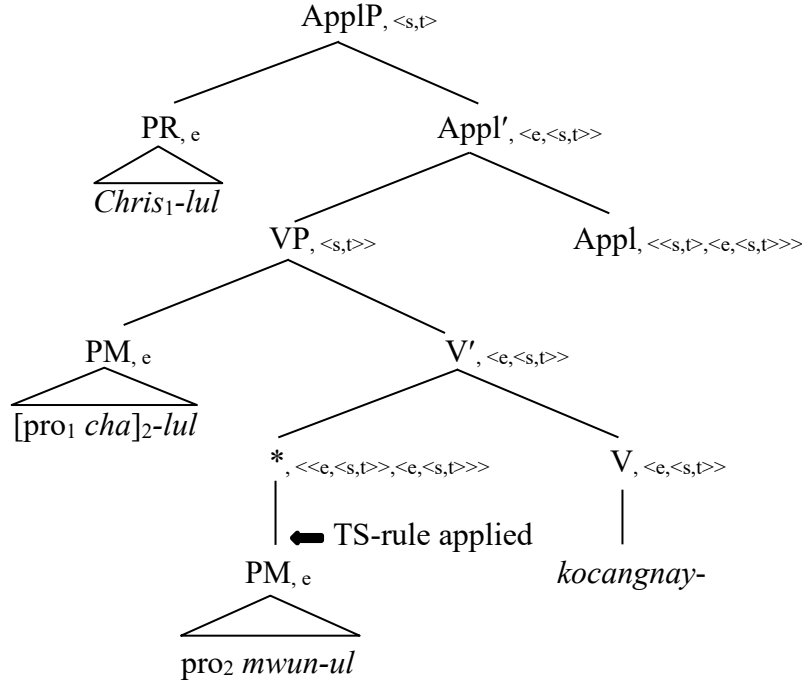
c. *Abbreviated compositional derivation of (40b)*

$$\begin{aligned}
\llbracket V' \rrbracket^g &= \text{via FA} = \llbracket \bullet \rrbracket^g(\llbracket \mathbf{cap-} \rrbracket^g) = \text{from previous calculation} \\
&= \lambda P \lambda y \lambda e' [P(y)(e') \ \& \ \exists z [\text{Target}(z)(e') \ \& \ z = \text{the.end.of}(c_2)]] \\
&\quad (\lambda k \lambda e [\text{grab}(e) \ \& \ \text{Theme}(k)(e)]) = \text{via } \lambda\text{-reduction} \\
&= \lambda y \lambda e' [\text{grab}(e') \ \& \ \text{Theme}(y)(e') \ \& \ \exists z [\text{Target}(z)(e') \ \& \\
&\quad \& \ z = \text{the.end.of}(c_2)]] \\
\\
\llbracket V'' \rrbracket^g &= \text{via FA} = \llbracket * \rrbracket^g(\llbracket V' \rrbracket^g) \\
&= \lambda P \lambda x \lambda e [P(x)(e) \ \& \ \exists v [\text{Target}(v)(e) \ \& \ v = \text{the.arm.of}(t_1)_2]] \\
&\quad (\lambda y \lambda e' [\text{grab}(e') \ \& \ \text{Theme}(y)(e') \ \& \ \exists z [\text{Target}(z)(e') \ \& \\
&\quad \& \ z = \text{the.end.of}(c_2)]]]) = \text{via } \lambda\text{-reduction} \\
&= \lambda x \lambda e [\text{grab}(e) \ \& \ \text{Theme}(x)(e) \ \& \ \exists z [\text{Target}(z)(e) \ \& \\
&\quad \& \ z = \text{the.end.of}(c_2)] \ \& \ \exists v [\text{Target}(v)(e) \ \& \ v = \text{the.arm.of}(c_1)_2]] \\
\\
\llbracket VP \rrbracket^g &= \text{via FA} = \llbracket V'' \rrbracket^g(\llbracket \mathbf{Chris}_1 \rrbracket^g) \\
&= \text{from previous calculation \& by lexical entry} \\
&= \lambda x \lambda e [\text{grab}(e) \ \& \ \text{Theme}(x)(e) \ \& \ \exists z [\text{Target}(z)(e) \ \& \\
&\quad \& \ z = \text{the.end.of}(c_2)] \ \& \ \exists v [\text{Target}(v)(e) \ \& \\
&\quad \& \ v = \text{the.arm.of}(c_1)_2]](\text{Chris}_1) = \text{via } \lambda\text{-reduction} \\
&= \lambda e [\text{grab}(e) \ \& \ \text{Theme}(\text{Chris}_1)(e) \ \& \ \exists z [\text{Target}(z)(e) \ \& \\
&\quad \& \ z = \text{the.end.of}(c_2)] \ \& \ \exists v [\text{Target}(v)(e) \ \& \ v = \text{the.arm.of}(c_1)_2]] \\
&= \text{via variable assignment } g[1 \rightarrow \text{Chris}; 2 \rightarrow \text{Chris's car}] \\
&= \lambda e [\text{grab}(e) \ \& \ \text{Theme}(\text{Chris})(e) \ \& \ \exists z [\text{Target}(z)(e) \ \& \ z \\
&\quad = \text{the.end.of}(\text{the.arm.of}(\text{Chris}))] \ \& \ \exists v [\text{Target}(v)(e) \ \& \ v \\
&\quad = \text{the.arm.of}(\text{Chris})]]
\end{aligned}$$

Consider now (41). Although this sentence is superficially similar to (39), in the present analysis it instantiates a Type 2 case because the highest ACC-marked nominal is not the object of the verb. That said, the second and the third ACC-marked nominals stand in an inalienable part-whole relation. Hence, this sentence has the composition scheme given in (42a), which gives rise to its ApplP-level meaning given in (42b). Consequently, it will be true if in the breaking event e under description, the Theme is Chris's car and the Target is her car's door and there is some e' such that e' is the Result of e and Chris is the Receiver of e' .

- (41) Pat-i **Chris-lul** **cha-ul** **mwun-ul** kocangnay-ss-ta.
Pat-NOM Chris-ACC car-ACC door-ACC break-PST-DECL
Lit.: 'Pat broke Chris the door of her car.'
Intended: 'Pat broke Chris's car door on her.'

- (42) a.
- ApplP-level compositional scheme for (41)*



- b.
- ApplP-level denotation of (41)*

$\llbracket \text{ApplP} \rrbracket = \lambda e [\text{break}(e) \ \& \ \text{Theme}(\text{the.car.of}(\text{Chris}))(e) \ \& \ \exists z [\text{Target}(z)(e) \ \& \ z = \text{the.door.of}(\text{the.car.of}(\text{Chris}))] \ \& \ \exists e' [\text{Result}(e')(e) \ \& \ \exists r [\text{Receiver}(r)(e') \ \& \ r = \text{Chris}]]]$

- c.
- Abbreviated compositional derivation of (42b)*

$\llbracket V' \rrbracket^g = \text{via FA} = \llbracket * \rrbracket^g (\llbracket \text{kocangnay-} \rrbracket^g)$
 $= \lambda P \lambda y \lambda e' [P(y)(e') \ \& \ \exists z [\text{Target}(z)(e') \ \& \ z = \text{the.door.of}(c_2)]]$
 $(\lambda k \lambda e [\text{break}(e) \ \& \ \text{Theme}(k)(e)]) = \text{via } \lambda\text{-reduction}$
 $= \lambda y \lambda e' [\text{break}(e') \ \& \ \text{Theme}(y)(e') \ \& \ \exists z [\text{Target}(z)(e') \ \& \ z = \text{the.door.of}(c_2)]]$

$\llbracket \text{VP} \rrbracket^g = \text{via FA} = \llbracket V' \rrbracket^g (\llbracket [\text{pro}_1 \text{ cha}]_2 \rrbracket^g)$
 $= \text{from previous calculation \& by lexical entry \& } \lambda\text{-reduction}$
 $= \lambda y \lambda e' [\text{break}(e') \ \& \ \text{Theme}(y)(e') \ \& \ \exists z [\text{Target}(z)(e') \ \& \ z = \text{the.door.of}(c_2)]] (\text{the.car.of}(c_1)_2) = \lambda\text{-reduction}$
 $= \lambda e' [\text{break}(e') \ \& \ \text{Theme}(\text{the.car.of}(c_1)_2)(e') \ \& \ \exists z [\text{Target}(z)(e') \ \& \ z = \text{the.door.of}(c_2)]]$

$\llbracket \text{Appl}' \rrbracket^g = \text{via FA} = \llbracket \text{Appl} \rrbracket^g (\llbracket \text{VP} \rrbracket^g)$
 $= \text{by lexical entry \& from previous calculation}$
 $= \lambda Q \lambda x \lambda e [Q(e) \ \& \ \exists e' [\text{Result}(e')(e) \ \& \ \exists r [\text{Receiver}(r)(e') \ \& \ r = x]] \ \& \ (\lambda e' [\text{break}(e') \ \& \ \text{Theme}(\text{the.car.of}(c_1)_2)(e') \ \& \ \exists z [\text{Target}(z)(e') \ \& \ z = \text{the.door.of}(c_2)]])] = \text{via } \lambda\text{-reduction}$
 $= \lambda x \lambda e [\text{break}(e) \ \& \ \text{Theme}(\text{the.car.of}(c_1)_2)(e) \ \& \ \exists z [\text{Target}(z)(e) \ \& \ z = \text{the.door.of}(c_2)] \ \& \ \exists e' [\text{Result}(e')(e) \ \& \ \exists r [\text{Receiver}(r)(e') \ \& \ r = x]]]$

$$\begin{aligned}
[[\text{ApplP}]]^g &= \text{via FA} = [[\text{Appl}']]^g([[\text{Chris}_1]])^g \\
&= \text{from previous calculation \& by lexical entry} \\
&= \lambda x \lambda e [\text{break}(e) \& \text{Theme}(\text{the.car.of}(c_1)_2)(e) \& \exists z [\text{Target}(z)(e) \& \\
&\quad z = \text{the.door.of}(c_2)] \& \exists e' [\text{Result}(e')(e) \& \exists r [\text{Receiver}(r)(e') \& \\
&\quad r = x]]](\text{Chris}_1) = \text{via } \lambda\text{-reduction} \\
&= \lambda e [\text{break}(e) \& \text{Theme}(\text{the.car.of}(c_1)_2)(e) \& \exists z [\text{Target}(z)(e) \& \\
&\quad z = \text{the.door.of}(c_2)] \& \exists e' [\text{Result}(e')(e) \& \exists r [\text{Receiver}(r)(e') \& \\
&\quad r = \text{Chris}_1]]] \\
&= \text{via variable assignment } g[1 \rightarrow \text{Chris}; 2 \rightarrow \text{Chris's car}] \\
&= \lambda e [\text{break}(e) \& \text{Theme}(\text{the.car.of}(\text{Chris}))(e) \& \exists z [\text{Target}(z)(e) \& \\
&\quad z = \text{the.door.of}(\text{the.car.of}(\text{Chris}))] \& \exists e' [\text{Result}(e')(e) \& \\
&\quad \exists r [\text{Receiver}(r)(e') \& r = \text{Chris}]]]
\end{aligned}$$

5. A binding problem, a possible solution, and the implications

The analysis I am promoting in this paper has yet another welcome result: It gives us a new way of interpreting the binding problem noted by Tomioka and Sim (2007), and in so doing, it points to a possible solution to the problem, thereby suggesting that there is some truth to both possessor-raising and non-possessor-raising analyses of the ACC-marked EPC in Korean, unlike what is standardly held in the Korean linguistics literature (see, e.g., Yoon 2015).¹¹

To introduce what this binding problem is first: Tomioka and Sim observe that there is a sharp contrast in grammaticality between sentences like (43a) and (43b); and they claim that such contrasts arise because all ACC-marked EP sentences in Korean contain the invisible lexical verb *affect*, which is stacked on top of another lexical but phonologically non-null verb, as given in (44), and while the eventuality of hitting one of Chelswu's legs can be a material part of affecting Chelswu by himself, the eventuality of hitting his car by himself cannot be.¹²

- (43) a. Chelswu₁-ka **cakicasin₁-lul** **tali-lul** ttayli-ess-ta.
 Chelswu-NOM self-ACC leg-ACC hit-PST-DECL
 ‘Chelswu hit his own leg.’

¹¹For possessor-raising analyses, see, e.g., Chun 1985, Choe 1986, Ura 1996, and Cho 1998, 2000; for non-possessor-raising analyses, see, e.g., Kim 1989, 1990, Yoon 1989, 2015, Cho 1992, Yoon 1997, O'Grady 1998, 2002, Vermeulen 2005, Sim 2004, Tomioka and Sim 2005, 2007, and Shin 2008, 2022.

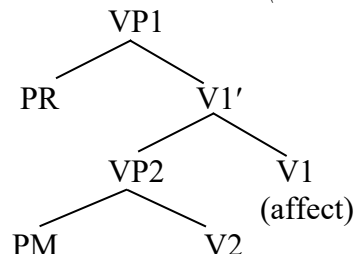
¹²The IP counterpart of (43b) is grammatical, as shown below, as is the IP counterpart of (43a).

- (i) a. Chelswu₁-ka **cakicasin₁-uy** **tali-lul** ttayli-ess-ta.
 Chelswu-NOM self-GEN leg-ACC hit-PST-DECL
 ‘Chelswu hit his own leg.’
 b. Chelswu₁-ka **cakicasin₁-uy** **cha-lul** ttayli-ess-ta.
 Chelswu-NOM self-GEN car-ACC hit-PST-DECL
 ‘Chelswu hit his own car.’

- b. *Chelswu₁-ka **cakicasin₁-lul** **cha-lul** ttayli-ess-ta.
 Chelswu-NOM self-ACC car-ACC hit-PST-DECL
 Intended: ‘Chelswu hit his own car.’

(Adapted from Tomioka and Sim 2007: (39a, b)¹³)

- (44) Tomioka and Sim’s (2007: (26)) proposal for the ACC-marked EPC in Korean



Tomioka and Sim’s explanation of the contrast between data like (43a) and (43b) is intuitively appealing, and it accounts for numerous other data that instantiate the ACC-marked EPC in Korean (e.g., (1a), (4)). However, as I have remarked in sections 1 and 2, and as pointed out by other authors also (e.g., Yoon 2015; Shin 2022), positing the invisible lexical verb *affect* in the structure of all ACC-marked EP sentences has several problems.

First, doing so cannot account for data like (5) and (6) since in such sentences the PM does not constitute a material part of the PR.

Second, Tomioka and Sim’s analysis leaves the grammaticality and interpretation of sentences like (2) unexplained: in (2), the PR and the PM do not stand in a material part-whole relation and yet the PR is interpreted as being affected by the action that was done to the PM.

Third, their analysis is afflicted by sentences like (39) and (41) where multiple ACC-marked nominals occur forming PR-PM pairs: since Tomioka and Sim treat *affect* as a lexical verb, they must posit that such sentences contain multiple occurrences of *affect* in their syntax but not all the PR nominals are construed as affected themes in the strictest sense of the term or as standing in a material part-whole relation to their PMs, as exemplified by *phal-ul* ‘the arm’ in (39) and *Chris-lul* in (41), respectively.

Finally, I should note that even sentences like (5) and (6) may have multiple occurrences of ACC-marked nominals as shown in (45), and they pose the same set of problems for Tomioka and Sim’s analysis as sentences like (39) and (41) do.

- (45) Context: In answer to “who knows the first letter of that kid’s name?”

JOHN-i **ku** **ai-lul** **ilum-ul** **ches.kulca-lul**
 John-NOM that kid-ACC name-ACC first.letter-ACC
 al-n-ta.
 know-IMPRF-DECL
 ‘JOHN knows the first letter of that kid’s name.’

¹³In their original data, Tomioka and Sim (2007) use *caki* as the reflexive pronoun that occurs as the PR, but I have replaced it with *caki casin* because both to my Korean consultants’ and to my ear, their (39b) (which corresponds to my (43a)) does not sound grammatical. That said, using *caki casin* instead of *caki* does not change the points I am trying to make here.

Min-Joo Kim

To circumvent the problems posed by sentences like (5) and (6), Tomioka and Sim suggest that such cases exemplify a different kind of construction than sentences like (1a), (43a), and (43b) because the verbs involved are of different kinds. However, when it comes to reflexive binding, they exhibit similar patterns: as one can see from considering (46)–(49), even if the main verb of an ACC-marked EP sentence is ‘to like’ or ‘to know’, a reflexive cannot occur as the PR *if* the PM is *not* an inalienable part of it. This shows that what is at issue for the binding problem observed by Tomioka and Sim is not whether the PM is a material part of the PR or not, but whether it is an *inalienable part* of it or not. And the contrast between the data in (46)–(49) further shows that even for a famous singer, their songs may not be a truly inalienable part of them, unlike what Shin (2022) claims. Therefore, I conclude that in Korean ACC-marked EP sentences, only *truly inalienably possessed* PMs may occur bound by a reflexive that occurs as the PR in the same sentence, regardless of whether they are a physical part of the PR or not.

- (46) a. Taylor Swift₁-ka **cakicasin₁-uy** **sengkyek-ul** (IPC)
Taylor Swift-NOM self-GEN personality-ACC
cohaha-n-ta.
like-IMPRF-DECL
‘Taylor Swift likes her own personality.’
- b. Taylor Swift₁-ka **cakicasin₁-lul** **sengkyek-ul** (EPC)
Taylor Swift-NOM self-ACC personality-ACC
cohaha-n-ta.
like-IMPRF-DECL
‘Taylor Swift likes her own personality.’ Or
‘It is Taylor Swift who likes her own personality.’
- (47) a. Taylor Swift₁-ka **cakicasin₁-uy** **nolay-lul** (IPC)
Taylor Swift-NOM self-ACC song-ACC
cohaha-n-ta.
like-IMPRF-DECL
‘Taylor Swift likes her own songs.’
- b. */??Taylor Swift₁-ka **cakicasin₁-lul** **nolay-lul** (EPC)
Taylor Swift-NOM self-ACC song-ACC
cohaha-n-ta.
like-IMPRF-DECL
Intended: ‘Taylor Swift likes her own songs.’ Or
‘It is Taylor Swift who likes her own songs.’
- (48) a. Taylor Swift₁-ka **cakicasin₁-uy** **tancem-ul** (IPC)
Taylor Swift-NOM self-ACC shortcoming-ACC
al-n-ta.
know-IMPRF-DECL
‘Taylor Swift knows her own shortcomings.’

- b. Taylor Swift₁-ka **cakicasin₁-lul** **tancem-ul** (EPC)
 Taylor Swift-NOM self-ACC shortcoming-ACC
 al-n-ta.
 know-IMPRF-DECL
 ‘Taylor Swift knows her own shortcomings.’ Or
 ‘It is Taylor Swift who knows her own shortcomings.’
- (49) a. Taylor Swift₁-ka **cakicasin₁-uy** **cwuso-lul** (IPC)
 Taylor Swift-NOM self-ACC address-ACC
 al-n-ta.
 know-IMPRF-DECL
 ‘Taylor Swift knows her own home address.’
- b. *Taylor Swift₁-ka **cakicasin₁-lul** **cwuso-lul** (EPC)
 Taylor Swift-NOM self-ACC address-ACC
 al-n-ta.
 know-IMPRF-DECL
 Intended: ‘Taylor Swift knows her own home address.’ Or
 ‘It is Taylor Swift who knows her own home address.’

Where does this leave us with regard to the binding problem presented by the ACC-marked EPC in Korean? In answer to this question, I would like to suggest that we obtain the contrast between (43a) and (43b), as well as the contrasts between (46b)/(48b) and (47b)/(49b), because the former has a different kind of empty category occur in the PM-internal position than in the latter case and this has a consequence for binding. To be more specific, in data like (43a), (46b), and (48b), a PRO occurs in the PM-internal position (50), whereas in data like (43b), (47b), and (49b), a *pro* occurs in the corresponding position (51), and since a *pro* cannot be bound by a reflexive per Binding Condition B (Chomsky 1981), the latter set of data are judged to be ungrammatical.¹⁴

- (50) *Binding configuration for sentences like (43a), (46b), and (48b)*
 $\sqrt{[Subject_1 \quad [VP \ [DP \ \textbf{cakicasin}_1] \quad [V' \ [DP \ \textbf{PRO}_1 \ \textit{tali/sengkyek/tancem}]\text{-ul} \ V]]]}$

- (51) *Binding configuration for sentences like (43b), (47b), and (49b)*
 $*[Subject_1 \quad [VP \ [DP \ \textbf{cakicasin}_1] \quad [V' \ [DP \ \textbf{pro}_1 \ \textit{cha/nolay/cwuso}]\text{-lul} \ V]]]$

Having said that, we must take into account the fact that even if the PR and the PM of an ACC-marked EP sentence stand in an inalienable possession relation to each other, a resumptive possessor pronoun may occur inside the PM’s projection *if* the PR is not a reflexive, as shown in (52)–(53), repeated from (18)–(19) with a different gender marking on *Chris* (cf. Cho 1992; Vermeulen 2005, among others).

¹⁴For this idea to work, the SpecDP position that PRO occupies in (50) must be a Case-less position, whereas the SpecDP position that *pro* occupies in (51) is a case/Case position in the sense that it can receive GEN. Proving that the former is indeed a Case-less position will take us too far afield, however. Therefore, in this paper, I simply assume that for reasons that we do not fully understand at this point, a PRO may be base-generated in the syntactic environment represented in (50).

Min-Joo Kim

- (52) *Variant of (1a) with overt possessor pronoun occurring inside the PM*
 Pat-i **Chris₁-lul** [kunye₁-uy **phal**]-ul
 Pat-NOM Chris-ACC she-GEN arm-ACC
 cap-ass-ta.
 grab-PST-DECL
 ‘Pat grabbed Chris₁ by her₁ arm.’
- (53) *Variant of (2) with overt possessor pronoun occurring inside the PM*
 Pat-i **Chris₁-lul** [kunye₁-uy **cha**]-lul
 Pat-NOM Chris-ACC she-GEN car-ACC
 kocangnay-ss-ta.
 break-PST-DECL
 ‘Pat broke Chris₁’s car on her₁.’

In light of this, I submit that when a PR that occurs in an ACC-marked EP sentence stands in an inalienable possession relation to the PM, either a PRO or a *pro* may occur in the PM-internal position, provided that the outcome complies with the binding principles; if the PR stands in an alienable possession relation to the PM, then only a *pro* may occur in the PM-internal position.

- (54) *Schema for cases where the PR and the PM stand in an inalienable relation*
 [Subject [VP [DP **PR**₁] [V' [DP **PRO**₁/*pro*₁ **PM**]-ACC V]]]
- (55) *Schema for cases where the PR and the PM stand in an alienable relation*
 [Subject [VP [DP **PR**₁] [V' [DP *pro*₁ **PM**]-ACC V]]]

To summarize, then, our discussion in this section has revealed at least three things for us.

First, in Korean, a PM’s ability to occur in environments like (43) and (46)–(49) is a potentially foolproof diagnostic with which to determine its truly inalienable status.

Second, Korean ACC-marked EP sentences in which all the PR-PM pairs stand in truly inalienable possession relations have more than one syntactic possibility: they can have either a *pro* or a PRO occur inside the PM nominal, bearing the same index as the PM-externally occurring PR.

Third, if what I have proposed in (50)–(51) and (54)–(55) is correct, then there is a way to incorporate the insights of the possessor-raising analyses of the ACC-marked EPC in Korean but without running into the same problems as they do (e.g., their inability to capture the fact that not every IP sentence has an EP counterpart and that there is a semantic difference between an IP sentence and its EP counterpart) since on the picture I presented here, what they would claim to be the trace of a moved PR can be analyzed as a PRO (cf. Hornstein 1999; Lee-Schoenfeld 2006).

Of course, the question that arises at this point is: why do nominals encoding a truly inalienable possession relation have such “privileged” status in the sense that when they occur in an ACC-marked EP sentence, the PM-internal position may have a *pro* or a PRO,

whereas nominals encoding a non-truly inalienable possession relation may only have a *pro* occur in that position?

Obviously, providing a satisfactory answer to this question will go well beyond the scope of this paper; therefore, I must leave it to future research.

6. Conclusion

This paper has sought to identify the licensing conditions for the ACC-marked EPC in Korean, and in this process, it has made three central claims. First, sentences instantiating the ACC-marked EPC in Korean must answer the QUD. Second, they have what I call Type 1 and Type 2 syntax depending on the thematic roles the PR and the PM bear in the event under description. Third, even among Type 1 cases, at least two sub-types can be identified depending on whether the PR and the PM at issue stand in a truly inalienable possession relation or not.

If correct, the analysis presented here provides an explanation for why no previously suggested licensing condition works for all cases, be it the affectedness condition (Yoon 1989, 1990), the physical contiguity condition (Yeon 1999, 2019), the material part of condition (Tomioka and Sim 2005, 2007), or the inalienable part of condition (Shin 2022). It also explains why no syntactic analysis previously proposed has been fully successful. The reason is that in Korean EP sentences, some ACC-marked PRs are direct objects but some are applied arguments, and correlatively, some ACC-marked PMs are V complements which function as predicates of events but some are direct objects (compare, a.o., Choe 1986; Kim 1989, 1990; Cho 1998, 2000; O'Grady 1998, 2002; Sim 2004; Tomioka and Sim 2005, 2007; Vermeulen 2005; Kitaoka 2017; Shin 2022).

In summary, the present paper has shown that there is more than one pathway to ACC-marked EP in Korean (cf. Deal 2013, 2017). This is not such a surprising discovery, however, because in other languages too (e.g., French, German, Flemish, Mandarin, Hebrew) EPCs have been shown to fall into more than one type and as such they call for different syntactic and semantic treatments (see, e.g., Vergnaud and Zubizarreta 1992; Lee-Schoenfeld 2006; Buelens 2014, 2016; Ke 2023; Borer and Grodzinsky 1986; Landau 1999). It remains to be seen how the analysis I have proposed in this paper extends to other languages since, even though no two languages behave identically, what has been referred to as the affectedness condition and the physical contiguity condition in the Korean linguistics literature are well documented to be at work in numerous other languages (as I have remarked in footnotes 2 and 9).

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